

ed to be run for any practicable purpose, and act solely as ‘bait’ to trap and detect the presence of an active virus.

Bimorphic Virus

An encrypted virus that has two forms of the decryption code, usually randomly selecting between them when writing its decryptor to a new replicant.

Binder

A tool that combines two or more files into a single file, usually for the purpose of hiding one of them.

BIOS

Basic Input/Output System is the lowest level program in a PC, which provides an interface with the PC’s hardware. A PC’s BIOS is also responsible for initiating the operating system bootstrap process by loading the boot sector of a diskette or the master boot record of a hard drive and passing control to it.

ActiveX

ActiveX controls are software modules based on Microsoft’s Component Object Model (COM) architecture. On the Internet, ActiveX controls can be linked to Web pages and downloaded by an ActiveX-compliant browser. ActiveX controls turn Web pages into software pages that perform like any other program launched from a server, and can have full system access. In most instances this access is legitimate, but one should be cautious of malicious ActiveX applications.

Attachments

Attachments are files added to an outgoing e-mail. In Microsoft e-mail clients, e-mail carrying an attachment will have a paper-clip type icon beside the description. Also in Microsoft e-mail clients, an icon representing the file type will be embedded at the end of the body of the e-mail message. Attachments have become a known harbinger of virus infection. Virus authors and distributors often give the file a double extension. Users who do not have proper viewing settings configured in Internet Explorer